

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

2 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣ A

[showcards W:CA N:C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 2

Play the ♣ 3.

If you signal with the ♣ 9 East will continue with the ♣ K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣ J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦ K, return the ♣ 9 back to East's ♣ K, and still have your trump trick for later.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 6 4 2
♥ J 6 3
♦ A J 6
♣ 10 7 3

♠ 9 3
♥ 5 4
♦ Q 10 8 3
♣ J 9 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5
♥ A K Q 8 7 2
♦ K 5 4
♣ A Q

♠ A K Q 10 7
♥ 10 9
♦ 9 7 2
♣ K 8 4

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by East			
Lead: ♠A			

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠A, North plays the ♠9, East the ♠5. You assume North has signaled you to continue ♠s, so you play the ♠Q. On this trick North plays the ♠3 and East the ♠8. How will you continue?

You know that both North and East are now void of ♠s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠Q, North won't bother ruffing, East **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠. North will ruff and East will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of West's ♠J. As you can see, East would have been able to discard a loser on that ♠J if you hadn't played this way.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 3
 ♥ Q J 10 7
 ♦ 8 5 2
 ♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5



♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that South started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and South won the ♥A.

South now plays the ♦J on which West plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when South plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

North hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the North hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that South plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what West plays. On the ♦J West

This defense holds South to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 10 6 4

♦ K 7 2

♣ 10 5 2



♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 8 7

♦ Q 6 5

♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3

West

1 ♣

2NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♥4

win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

3NT

South

Pass

[showcards S:ST]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, South plays the ♥J, won by West with ♥A.

West plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and South plays the ♠2. West continues with the ♠10

Play the ♠6.

South's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since West also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

West may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out West's ♥K. You will